France and Germany placed Masood Azhar on their proscribed lists, and both were very helpful in persuading the European Union to put Masood Azhar on the EU list of global terrorists. Meanwhile, the Americans decided to up the ante by taking the matter directly to the UN Security Council. This was unprecedented and threatened to precipitate a crisis since the topmost UN body for peace and security had never witnessed a division of vote over a terrorism-related matter. The Chinese tried to use this new development to advance their interests; they see any crisis as an opportunity and rarely give up any situation as a lost cause. Therefore, they viewed the US move to take the matter to the Security Council as a possible opportunity to buy time until the results of the Indian election were clear by the end of May 2019.

The Chinese threatened to deadlock the UN Security Council by exercising their veto. They presumed that this was not desirable from India's perspective because it might close the matter once and for all. Having failed to delay this matter on their own, they tapped a common friend to help them out of a sticky situation. They used the Russians to send this message to India. [10] Russia shared similar interests on many issues with China in the Security Council and needed Chinese support for its own multilateral agenda. At the same time, India was a strategic partner of Russia's. Russia urged India to allow the matter to be handled procedurally in the 1267 Committee rather than inside the Security Council, which was a political body. They pleaded that bringing this matter to the Security Council would politicize the issue and impair the Council's credibility. The Russians also indicated that Pakistan was ready to present a specific roadmap with timelines for the listing of Masood Azhar. The Russians claimed that it was the Americans who were being unreasonable in the matter by refusing to even acknowledge Pakistan's sincerity in resolving the matter.